CIT SPLASH Website

Connie Justice

Garret Ogden

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Table of Contents:

Project Introduction ……. 3

Scope of Work ……. 3

Technical Documentation ……. 4

Task Completed …… 5

Comparison Images ……... 6-10

Login Information …… 11-13

Colors Used …… 14

Recommendations for Future Work …… 15

References …… 16

Project Introduction:

For the summer semester living lab, I was assigned the task of recreating the CIT SPLASH website. The Splash website is a IUPUI site to be used to help future students apply for placement test, as well as seeing what courses they may be able to test out of within the CIT program. The current client is Dr. Connie Justice with IUPUI and the school of Engineering and Technology. The client came to us in need of a website redesign, given that the university no longer uses the design currently in use. As of right now, from what I could find, the one student who has worked on the Splash site besides myself is Sam Shrock. As of right now, the current my current progress is that I am done with the project and am currently waiting for it to be published.

Scope of Work:

In terms of the scope of work currently, I would like to get the new website up and running/published. As well as being able to create something that looks nice and clean. The deliverables for this project are mostly the in-class assignments as well as the final deliverables at the end of the semester. Currently, the past documentation consists of multiple student surveys, and a Degree Completion grant. This grant documents the overall purpose of SPLASH and some of the features to be included in future updates. As of right now, in terms of accomplishments on the site, I have been able to create mockup designs of all the pages and subpages of the new site.

A colleague and I have also been successful in migrating the new design of the site into the Word Press software as a custom theme. I have been able to successfully create the website and its multiple pages on Word Press. Lastly, I have added more content to the FAQ section of

the site, as well as fixing a few small page errors such as increasing the size of the title and fixing the height of the footer and making it more mobile friendly. The last accomplishment I plan to make on the site before presenting would be adding a mobile friendly "hamburger" menu, for easier and cleaner navigation when on a mobile device. The overall deadline for this project is to be completed on Friday, August 6th, 2021, or sooner if possible.

Technical Documentation:

Starting out on this new project, I first began by going over the current Splash website and its overall design. I had then concluded that even though a lot of the design would be scrapped, I wanted to keep certain parts of the site's design and layout in my final product. I decided that I would like to keep the layout of the site but update it to a more modern color scheme ad layout. More so being a companion site to our currently used design on the actual university site. After looking over the site, I decided to then begin creating Adobe XD design boards of what I wanted the new site to look like.

Below are the task I have completed so far on the project with time estimates on each task. Located on the following pages after the task are four photos, the first two images are the current Splash page, and my redesign of the home page. The last two images afterwards are what the original website and the redesign look like on a mobile phone. Once the mockups were done, I then had my client look over the design for approval. After getting approved, I finally began coding the website in the PHP Storm software to then be transferred over to a Word Press theme. Lastly, I wanted to meet with another classmate to try and get some assistance in converting my site into a Word Press theme to continue my work on there. Finally, I was successful in making

the final site mobile friendly. Now, the website works on a phone with a hamburger menu acting as the main navigation and the images being scaled properly.

Task Completed:

- Viewing current Splash website & deciding on a plan of action (1 hour).
- Creating XD design of all 15 pages for new site (14 hours/2 workdays).
- Coding new site in PHP Storm (14 hours/2 workdays).
- Meeting with fellow classmates to get current design over to Word Press software (7 hours/1 workday).
- Creating and designing the overall site in Word Press (7 hours/1 workday).
- Creating new buttons for the site with new colors and on hover color change (14 hours/2 workdays).
- Fixing formatting of website (14 hours/2 workdays).
- Making web page mobile friendly (4 workdays/2 work weeks).
- Created a hamburger menu for the mobile version of the site (7 hours/1 workday).
- Fixed staff profile photos to have a better shape and added in Discord link (7 hours/1 workday).

Found below are seven images, with figures. Listing the beginnings of the project with the original site as it was before, the Adobe XD created artboard used in the redesign, as well as the completed redesign both on the web and on mobile. Also listed are images/figures showing both the Word Press login screen, as well as the cPanel login screen. I have also listed the directions, or file structure, for finding the CSS file used to create the University theme used for the new website.

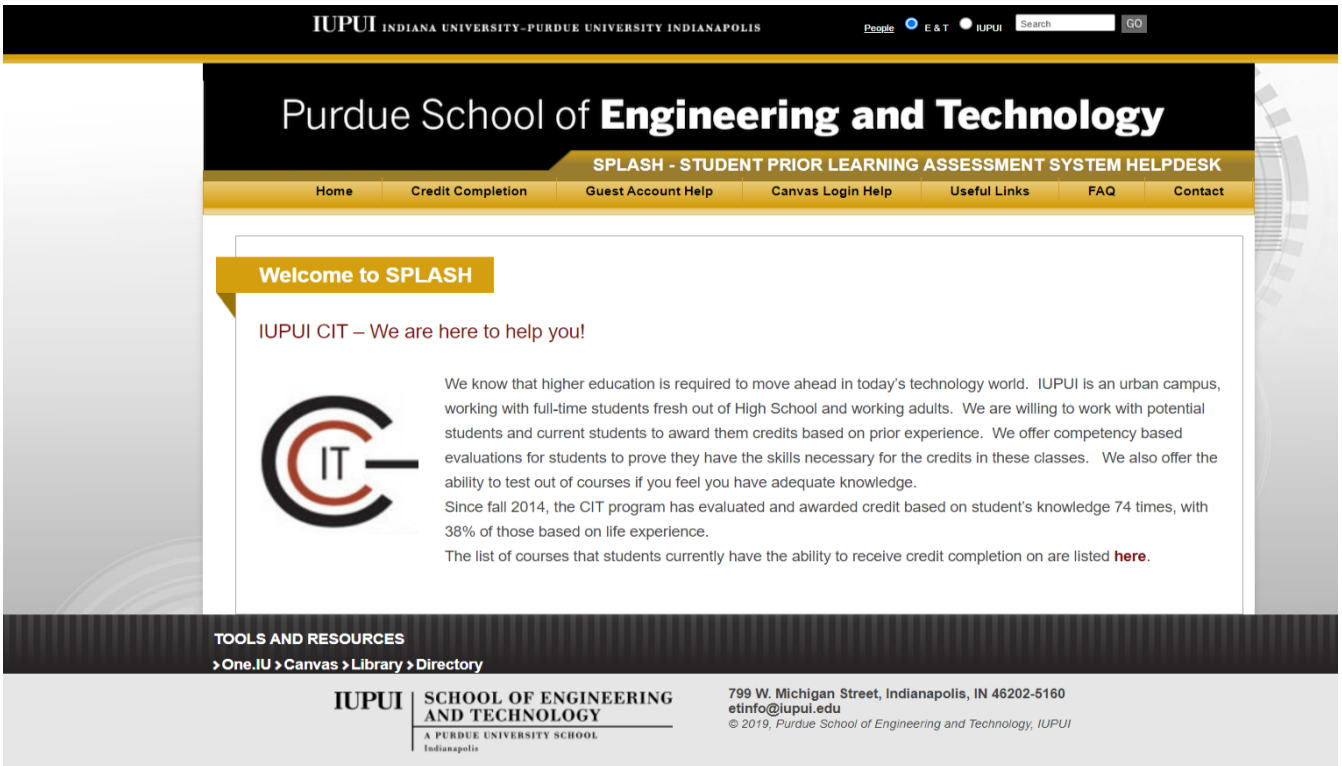

Figure 1: Original SPLASH homepage (Web)

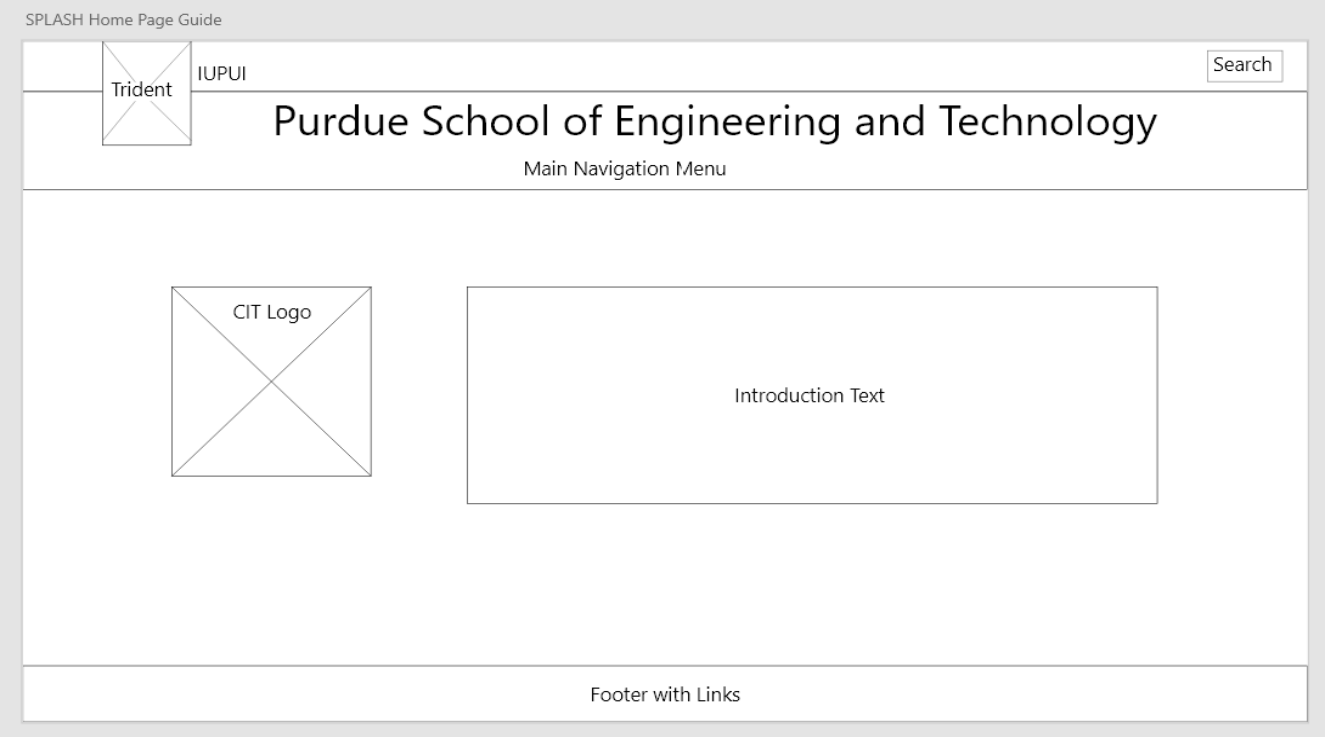

Figure 2: New Redesign Guide in Adobe XD

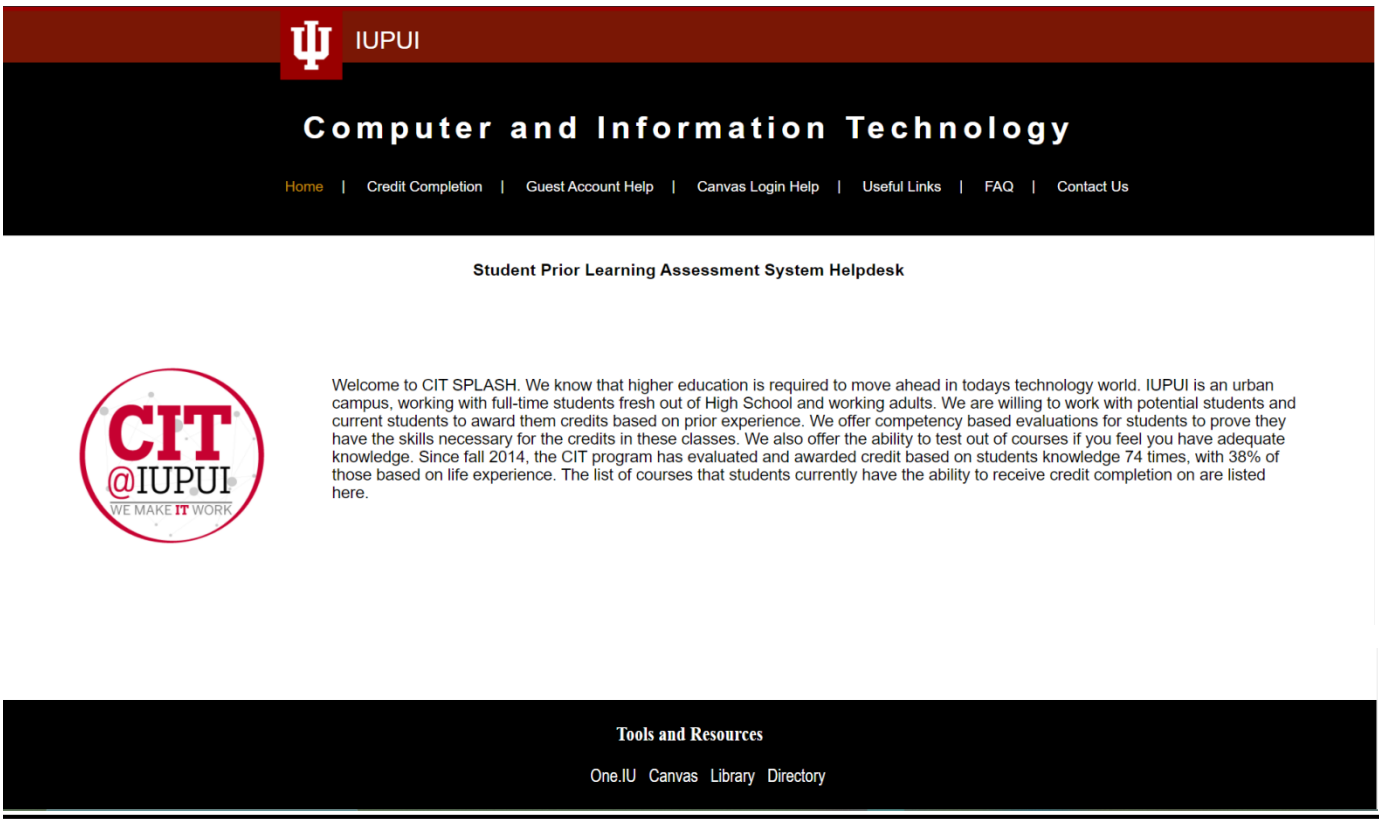

Figure 3: Final Redesign of SPLASH Homepage (Web)

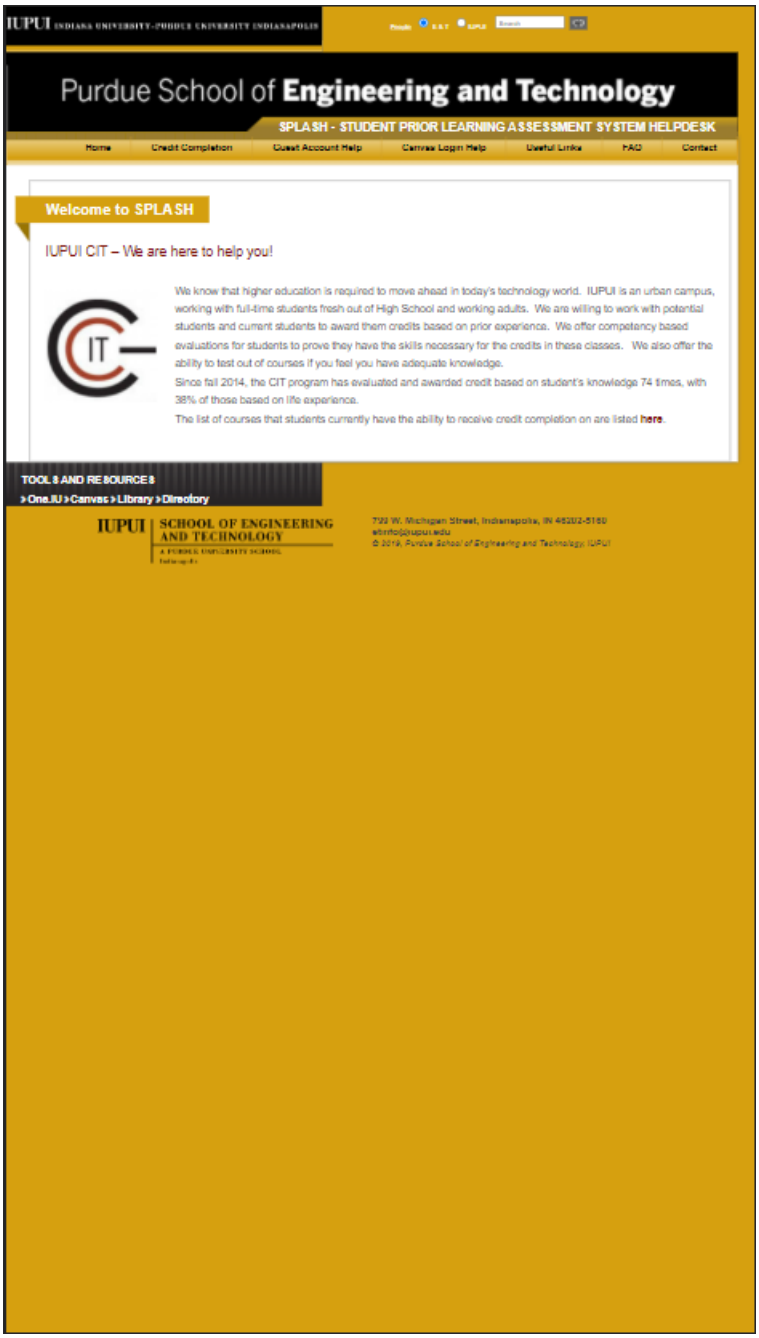

Figure 4: Original Website on Mobile (iPhone 8)

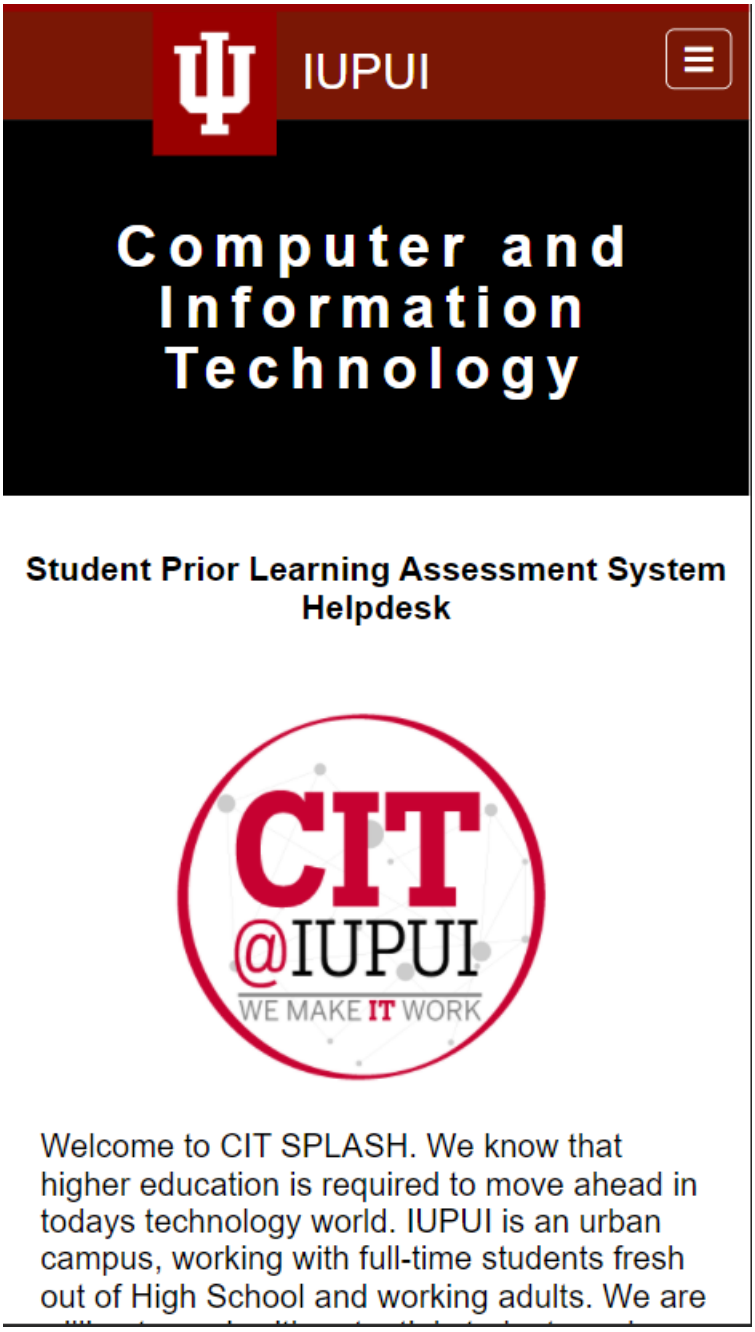

Figure 5: Redesign on Mobile (iPhone 8)

Listed below are the plugins used to create and edit portions of the website, along with how to use them. I also wanted to list the colors used within the site, as well as the login information for the Word Press development area and the cPanel server site, where the website code lives.

Logging into Splash development page:

Link to new Splash website (Development Area): https://livinglab-dev.org/splash/wp-admin/

Username: "**admin**"

Password: "**pass**"

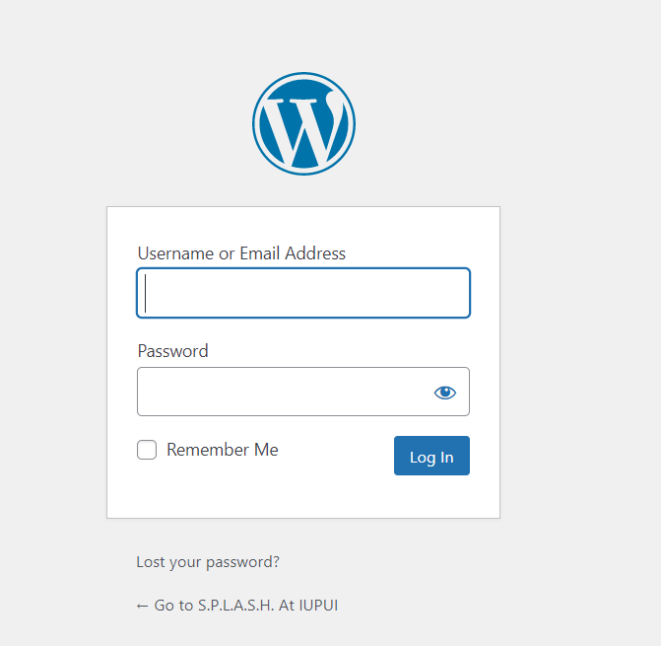

Figure 6: Word Press login screen

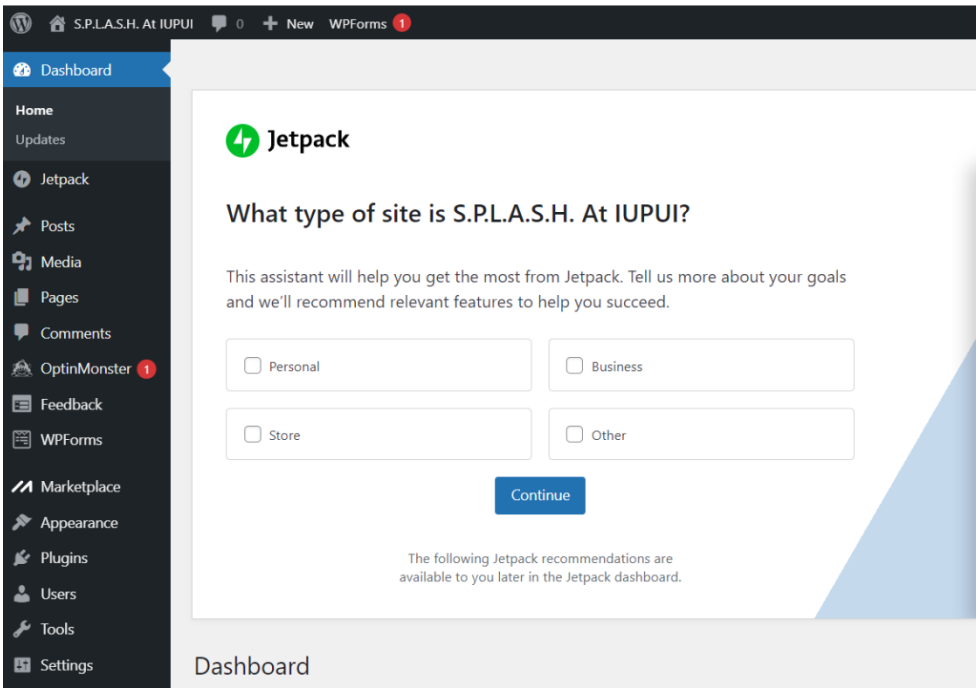

Figure 7: Word Press Dashboard

Logging into cPanel:

Username: "**citadmin**"
Password: "**m$G+Z/=70Pf(RApz#?nm**"

Link to cPanel: https://livinglab-dev.org:2083/

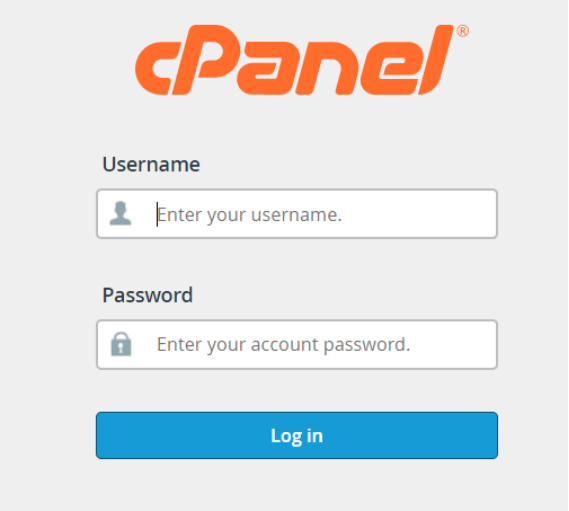

Figure 8: cPanel login screen

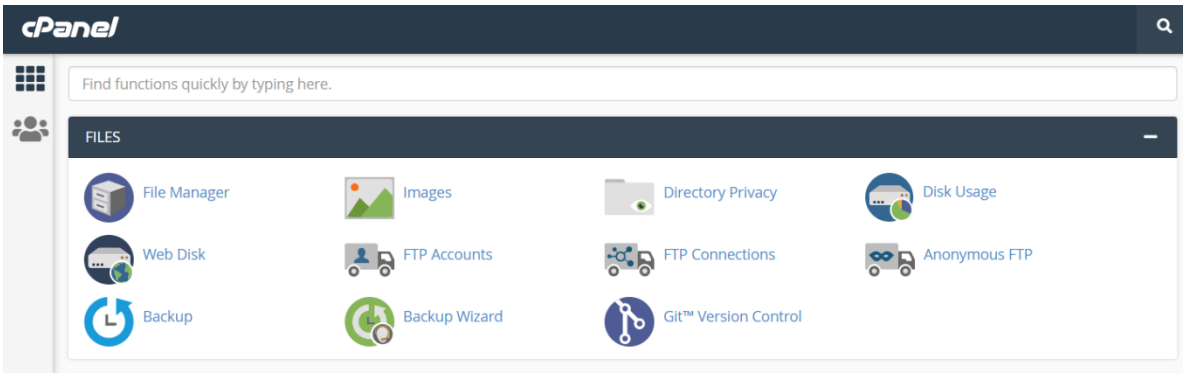

Figure 9: cPanel home page

Accessing CSS file/Theme on cPanel:

After logging into the cPanel website, to get to the index.css file to edit the Splash theme, follow these steps. First, got to the "**File Manager**", then, click "**public html**", go to the "**Splash**" tab, click on "**wp-content**", afterwards click "**themes**", "**splash theme**" and finally click the file named "**style.css**".

File Manager > public_html > splash > wp-content > themes >splash theme > style.css

Next, I would like to quickly discuss the plugin that I used for portion of the site, called Kadence Blocks. Kadence Blocks is a free Word Press plugin that allows the user to use the basic Word Press block editor in a more feature rich way, adding more options to edit and create more unique buttons, an image gallery and more. Below are the steps for downloading and using the new plugin.

Steps for Kadence Blocks plugin:

1. Search for "Kadence Blocks" in the search bar in the "Plugins section on Word Press and download. (Kadence will already be installed and active for this site, but this will act as a good tutorial on how to install and activate a new plugin.)

2. Install the plugin and click "activate" to implement the plugin on your block editor.

3. Once activated, go to the page you want to edit and by the block editor click on the Kadence "K" symbol to get to the block controls.

4. After selecting the Kadence controls, select the item or object you would like to edit or create

in the list provided. Once done, a small popup will appear asking you to specify the specifics of the item block you would like to create.

To end this section, I would also like to go over the colors and the HEX values that were used in this new Splash page.

- Colors Used:

  Crimson Red HEX Value: **#990000**

  Purdue Gold HEX Value: **#C28E0E**

  Black HEX Value: **#000000**

  White HEX Value: **#FFFFFF**

I chose these four colors because I wanted the new site design to be as close to the current IUPUI website design as possible. I also wanted to try and keep it simple, only using the four colors, instead of using a larger amount than needed.

Future Work Recommendations:

In case work on this project continues further, I have listed my recommendations below:

- Add in the correct footer with the school information, after the tools and resources footer, if possible.
- Add a FAQ section for faculty and staff in the FAQ page.
- Finish contacting course coordinators asking what documents the student needs to submit for testing out. (Please contact Vicky Smith about their networking classes listed in the "Test Out" section).
- Implement/create a submission feature or form to give students a way to submit their required documentation.
- Create a way for staff members to track student progress when they submit a file needed.

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